

TOPIC 4: PAPER CRAFT

1. Meaning of Paper Craft

Paper craft is the art of making useful or decorative objects from paper or cardboard by cutting, folding, rolling, gluing, weaving or assembling. It is one of the simplest and most accessible forms of craft because paper is cheap and easy to obtain.

Paper craft develops creativity, fine motor skills, patience and the ability to follow instructions. It is widely used in schools for projects and exhibitions.

2. Materials and Tools for Paper Craft

- Different types of paper (plain, coloured, cardboard, tissue paper, old newspapers, magazines).
- Scissors and cutting knife (with adult supervision).
- Glue, gum or adhesive tape.
- Ruler and pencil.
- Eraser.
- Markers, crayons or coloured pencils for decoration.
- Stapler (optional).
- Compass and set square (for accurate shapes).

3. Methods of Folding Paper

Folding is a basic technique in paper craft. Common folds include:

a) Basic Folds

- Valley fold – paper is folded towards you, creating a V-shape.
- Mountain fold – paper is folded away from you, creating a raised ridge.
- Accordion (concertina) fold – continuous valley and mountain folds creating a zig-zag.

b) Origami (Japanese Paper Folding)

Origami is the art of folding paper into decorative shapes and figures (animals, flowers, boxes) without cutting or gluing. Simple origami models suitable for beginners include the paper boat, paper aeroplane, paper cup and simple flower.

c) Other Folding Techniques

- Rolling paper into tubes or beads for jewellery and decorations.
- Pleating for decorative borders and fans.
- Scoring and folding for clean edges on boxes and cards.

4. Paper Craft Production (Common Projects)

Students can produce many useful and decorative items:

- **Greeting Cards** – folded cards decorated with drawings, cut-outs or collage for birthdays, festivals and celebrations.
- **Paper Flowers and Garlands** – for decoration during parties and school events.
- **Paper Boxes and Containers** – for storing small items or as gift boxes.
- **Masks** – for drama, cultural displays and festivals.
- **Paper Beads and Jewellery** – rolled and varnished paper beads for necklaces and bracelets.
- **Wall Hangings and Mobiles** – decorative pieces for classrooms and homes.

- **Models and Puppets** – animals, vehicles, houses and hand puppets for storytelling.
- **Collage** – pictures created by pasting pieces of coloured paper or magazine cut-outs.
- **Paper Weaving** – strips of paper woven to make mats, bookmarks or decorative panels.
- **Lanterns and Decorations** – for festivals and classroom beautification.

5. Steps in Making a Simple Paper Craft (Example: Greeting Card)

1. Choose a suitable size of coloured or plain card/paper.
2. Fold the paper neatly in half (valley fold).
3. Plan the design (drawing, cut-out shapes, message).
4. Cut out decorative shapes if needed and arrange them.
5. Glue the decorations carefully onto the front of the card.
6. Write a neat message inside the card.
7. Allow the glue to dry completely before handling.

6. Uses of Paper Crafts

- Decoration for homes, classrooms and events.
- Greeting cards and gift items.
- Teaching aids and learning materials in school.
- Props for drama, dance and cultural performances.
- Recreational activity that develops creativity and hand skills.
- Low-cost materials for art exhibitions and competitions.
- Recycling of waste paper into useful objects (environmental benefit).

7. Summary

Paper craft is the creative use of paper to make useful and decorative objects through folding, cutting, gluing and assembling. It requires simple tools and materials and is ideal for beginners. Students can produce cards, flowers, boxes, masks, jewellery and many other items. Paper craft develops creativity, patience and practical skills while also promoting the recycling of paper.

End of Topic 4 – Paper Craft

— End of JSS 1 Cultural and Creative Arts First Term Notes —